GLOBAL TRADE OBSERVER

India Beyond India

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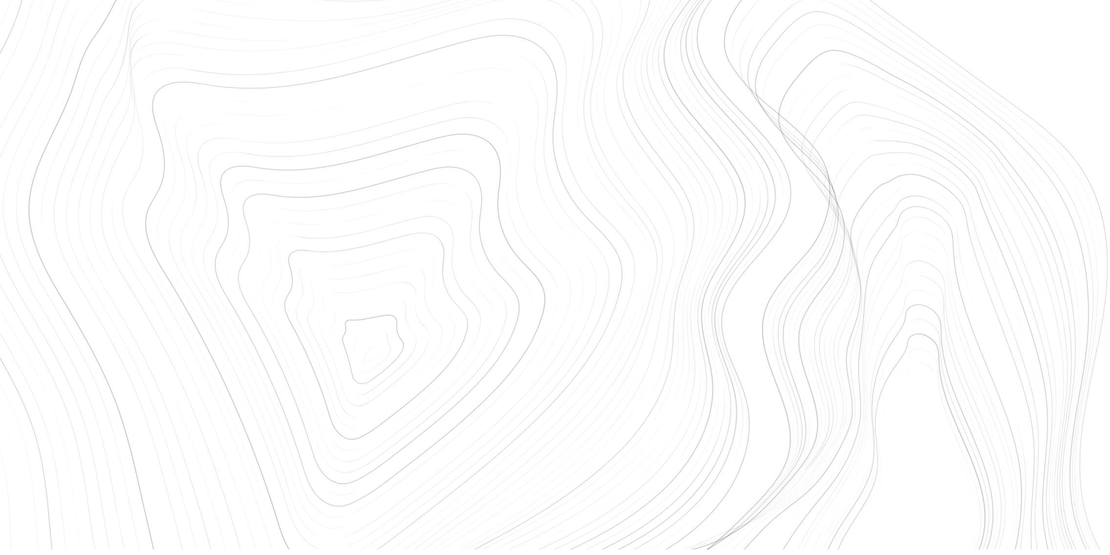


Solving Greatest Challenges Around Global Trade

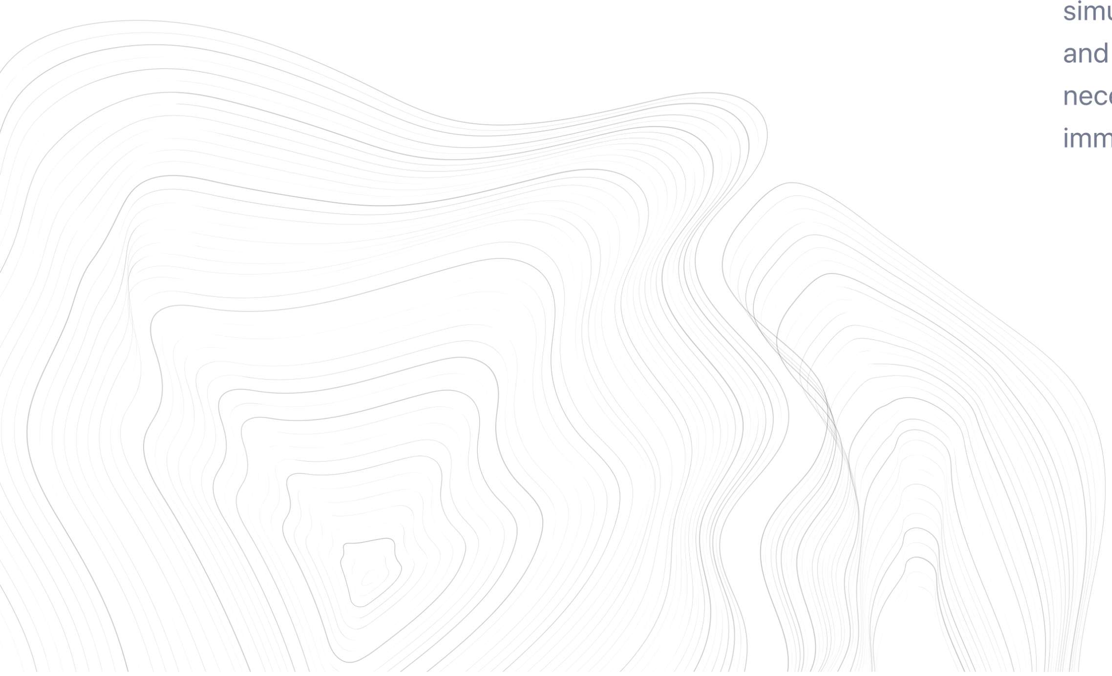
Welcome to the 21st Century Policy-making. Today, more than ever, India needs an independent source of evidence and insights to ensure that important decisions are rooted in reliable information. GTO aims to be that trusted source for various stakeholders viz. institutions, government agencies, academicians, policymakers, trade councils. We understand the actuality of constraints related to Cross Border Trade. Amalgamating this cognition with three decades of pedigree in empowering various industries in navigating the Foreign Trade Policy supported by a vast data repository for analytic interpretations allows us to provide real-world policy consensus of the finest quality. We are driven by the passion to decode and reconstruct the most complex policy frameworks through an advanced lens to ensure that India maximizes its trade potential and becomes a $5 Trillion economy.

Creating policy consensus of different persuasions to help devise pragmatic trade policy solutions thereby shaping global conversations and promoting trade growth

GTO deep dives into India's trade economy to present qualitative and well-researched analyses via strong research and data interpretation. This is done with the intent to share valuable insights and a 360-degree view of the current as well as the foreseeable implications of the Foreign Trade Policy of India. In the process of being a knowledge bank for various decision-makers, we act as a forum for discussions and opinion sharing from an array of stakeholders thus promoting a better understanding of the country's trade landscape, future potential and enabling ideation of policies. We aim to act as a catalyst in India's trade growth. We persuade impact-driven thought leadership which will lead to higher economic growth while aiding India's Foreign Trade Policy objectives.

What We Believe & Practice

We embrace challenges, take accountability and prudently traverse towards a meaningful goal. Our conscientious and concentrated actions which aim to enable India's growth are fueled with cognition and resilience. We are unique in our ability to simultaneously deliver the objectivity of data analysis and research, with the timeliness and accessibility necessary to create consensus and empower imminent decisions.



Complexity Simplified

We ride on logic and clarity. We provide a platform to facilitate difficult conversations and help solve complex problems.

Power of Action

We understand the pulse and requirements

Analyses over Assumptions

We disregard assumptions. We advocate modern policy-making powered by big data analysis and forecasting which helps predict the implications of today's actions, big or small.

Turning What into Why

across demographics after having operated in the trade domain for decades. Thus, we have the conviction to empower trade policies to achieve desired results.

Unconventional Strategic Thinking

We are synonymous with functional contextual intelligence. We identify opportunities that create value for all, thus forging international strategic partnerships and alliances.

It is not the answers that we are searching for, but the questions to ask. We share the deepest insights on the biggest challenges around world trade to propel growth.

Our Impact

We at GTO aim to equip our policy-makers with the necessary intel and data-driven insights to well-accomplish this challenging task.

One lackluster policy can push back the nation’s growth by years while one thoughtful intervention within time can ensure multifold progress.

To us, a thriving economy is one that is equitable, dynamic, and resilient, and if we can achieve this goal, we will see increased economic prosperity, opportunity, and participation.

We aspire to pave pathways of making India shine on the global stage. We strive to broaden the horizons of the nation by forging global collaborations for mutual benefits thus driving economic growth.

Our Manifesto

We believe in the power of actions driven by a purpose. It begins with asking the right questions, assessing the contemporary priorities, and ascertaining how changes would affect the lives and businesses of the people.

It requires humility to accept the reality of where we stand today and the audacity to remain untangled from politics and self-interest groups. It is necessary to be persistent in chasing the dream of bringing critical reforms and creating a border less world.

It thrives on taking accountability and being driven by a meaningful goal of changing the status quo and bringing substantial transformations, hence enabling free-flowing prosperity. It is about having the dynamism and versatility to bring transparency and clarity by scrutinizing traditionalistic thinking.

It is celebrating differences as signals of independent views and opinions which matters. A constant engagement with wise minds and big data analysis to understand the broader implications thus bringing seismic shifts.

It is prudent to be proactive and resilient but patient while moving towards achieving the vision. It is wisdom accumulated over three decades, a legacy that enriches the foundation.

Global Trade Observer: Setting stage for independent, impartial, selfless national trade growth, generating credible intelligence and sustained interactions across the borders - India Beyond India.

- Anirudh Bhagchandka

Design for change

How do we create impactful policy recommendations today, to ensure India maximises its trade potential and ultimately it’s GDP in the coming decades?

1. Identify

We begin with asking the right questions and understanding the essence of the problem. We have been co-existing with these challenges for decades, but the opportunity to innovate lies in re-defining these problems. We do not superficially list down ‘what’ the issues are, but get to the root cause to identify ‘why’ the issue exists. Uncovering the real challenge sets context of our problem solving journey.

2. Illuminate

The next step towards discovering the great answer lies in researching and developing an in-depth analysis. We notice the finer details and intricacies hidden in data patterns. This is coupled by real insights which come from venturing into the real world. We do not assume but discover the latent truth with our detailed scrutiny and progress in the correct direction.

3. Ideate

Comprehensive analysis and free-hand brainstorming unleashes the power of setting beyond the obvious solutions. We evaluate all possible strategies to bring about incremental improvements and ultimately breakthrough innovation. Our calling is to contribute to a larger purpose- making India a global trade superpower, and this further persuades us to solve challenges in the most unconventional ways.

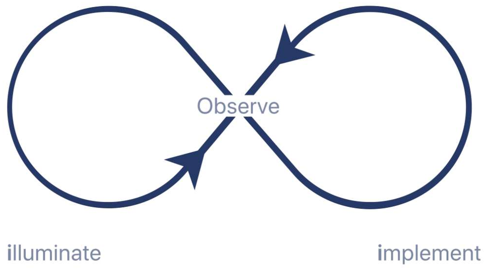
4.Implement

We utilise contextual intelligence to prototype and asses all the ideas before moving towards the final stage. We practice innovation which incites action. Radical transformation stems from execution of well laid out plans. To foster impactful innovation we collaborate with key stakeholders to facilitate real development

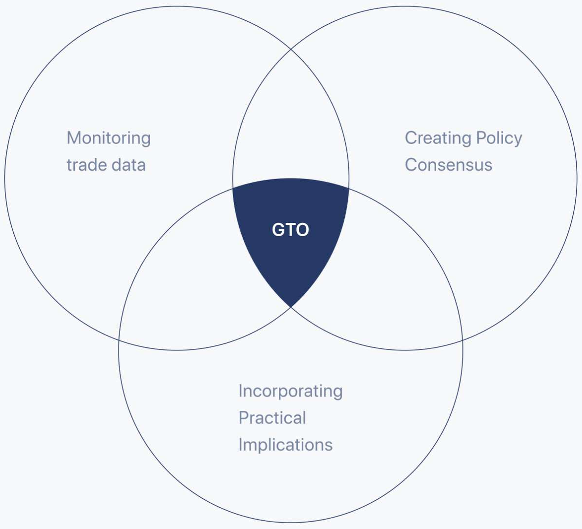
identity

ideate

At the heart of Infinite Innovation is Observation. At every stage of problem solving, keen observation empowers the effectiveness of our actions. It enables us to be receptive to feedback and understand the nuances holistically. Accumulation of all these constructive small steps thus helps us in achieving our goal.



The core of our innovation process ensures we work with stakeholders to create solutions that overcome challenges and develop opportunities that create value. The viability of this innovation is established by our methodology which creates an overlap of three critical factors -
big data analysis, intuitive intelligence of people, and practical on-ground realities.


Monitoring trade data
Creating Policy Consensus
GTO
Incorporating Practical Implications

Focus Areas

Trade Observations

Monitoring and transforming meaningless data into functional contextual intelligence.

Today, technology allows us to systematically structure large and complex data sets and utilise analytics to drive our efficiency and validate far-sighted policy recommendations. GTO roots the reliability of its recommendations through an intelligent, big-data driven system where we run 8 digit level HS code analysis at district level to review current status and policy implications, sectoral and geographic trends, movement of trade variables, trade competitiveness and growth areas identification. It is a collation of all available trade data sources with directly and indirectly related metrics from India's economy and sector trends that enable us to derive well rounded inferences and make evidence-based strategies

Policy Consensus

Harnessing power of many by connecting global leaders and thinkers across the world and domains

We set the context and bring all relevant stakeholders together to address difficult topics which create real impact. An opportunity is created where diverse point of views associated to the challenge at hand is heard. The forum stimulates better quality outcomes as knowledge and ideas flow in from varied researches, experiences, belief systems, geographies and also ensures that GTO's recommendations holistically address the objectives of all stakeholders impacted. Moreover this powerful process brings the entire community on the same page ultimately and the group cooperatively accepts a contentious decision, thus enhancing the ownership and commitment of working towards a common cause.

Thought Leadership

Orchestrating wisdom in action with coherent insights leading to well thought out recommendations

We view Trade Policy recommendations from a broader spectrum. Our policy recommendations take into account grassroot realities, need of various industries in India and trends in the global markets. The recommendation framework interlinks the data evidences, policy consensus created and actualities on ground. The Innovative proposal is then put forward to a larger audience whose commitment is to empower India’s trade economy with a ultimate objective to promote growth and development of the nation.

GTO works towards two objectives

Making India a Global Trade Superpower

Work at district, state, national level to identify, streamline and promote India’s trade competitiveness from the roots

For India to become a global trade superpower, it is necessary to encourage participation, transparency and consensus from the grassroots and across demographics. While prudently balancing the inverted duty structure of India, evolving policies with the the latest technological disruptions, GTO aims to advance India's trade domain holistically by - developing internal capabilities of the stakeholders across supply chain, creating an incubative external ecosystem for supplementing growth and regulatory transformations with on-ground implementation to make India unlock it's trade potential.

Creating India Beyond India

Work at international level to identify and resolve barriers to trade thus promoting seamless flow of India’s trade potential.

For India to become an export-led economy it is essential to revolutionalise how international alliances are forged. Enhanced market access, increased competitiveness, strategic partnerships are critical tools to further boost exports. We understand real-life challenges at policy-level, both at formulation and implementation stages and aim to bridge the gaps and remove any hinderances in seamless trade between India and the world. Global access and global scale will thus create an India beyond India and trigger further growth.

Some of the problem statements we observe

- **Prudent balancing of the inverted duty structure of India to ensure growth**
- **Impact, implications and future of tariff barriers**
- **Enhanced grassroot contribution to India’s cross border trade**
- **Evolving policies to harness power of technological disruptions**
- **Growing importance of international trade partnerships post Covid-19**

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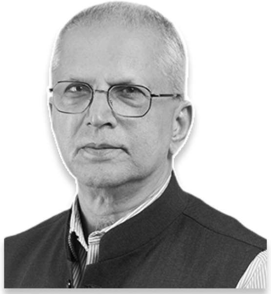
GTO Council

Dr. Harsha Vardhan Singh

With over three decades of extensive experience in international trade policy, development, infrastructure regulation and global governance, Dr. Singh has served the nation and the world at various platforms - Deputy Director General at World Trade Organization, Economic Adviser & Secretary to the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India, and Member of Global Agenda Council on Trade & FDI at the World Economic Forum. And now the young minds at GTO have an opportunity to brainstorm under his guidance.



Mr. G. K. Pillai

Former Union Home Secretary & Chief Negotiator for India at the World Trade Organisation, Mr. Pillai has operated in diverse Ministries; few of them being Defence, Surface Transport, Home and Commerce. He has played an active role in Kerala in various capacities – District Collector(Quilon), Special Secretary (Industries), Secretary (Health) and Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister. The team at GTO is honoured to research under his mentorship.

Dr. Rajat Kathuria

With over 25 years of experience in economic policy and reserach, Dr. Kathuria is the Former Director and Chief Executive at Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER). He has worked on various assignments with World Bank, International Labour Organization, United Nations Conference on Trade and Development. The GTO Change-Agents are thrilled to work under his directions.